

the results here," Sinner told Amritraj. "But I know how much I practise and dedicate myself to the sport. It's been an amazing year."

Indeed, it was for the carrot-loving Italian, whose penchant for the orange vegetable and curly, reddish-orange hair has inspired fans to don all kinds of orange costumes in his honour. Sinner started the year with a 22-27 career record against top-10 opponents but finished the season with a 17-5 record, winning 10 of his last 11 matches against them. With a terrific 70-6 match record, he has won eight tournaments — more than the number of matches he lost — a rare feat.

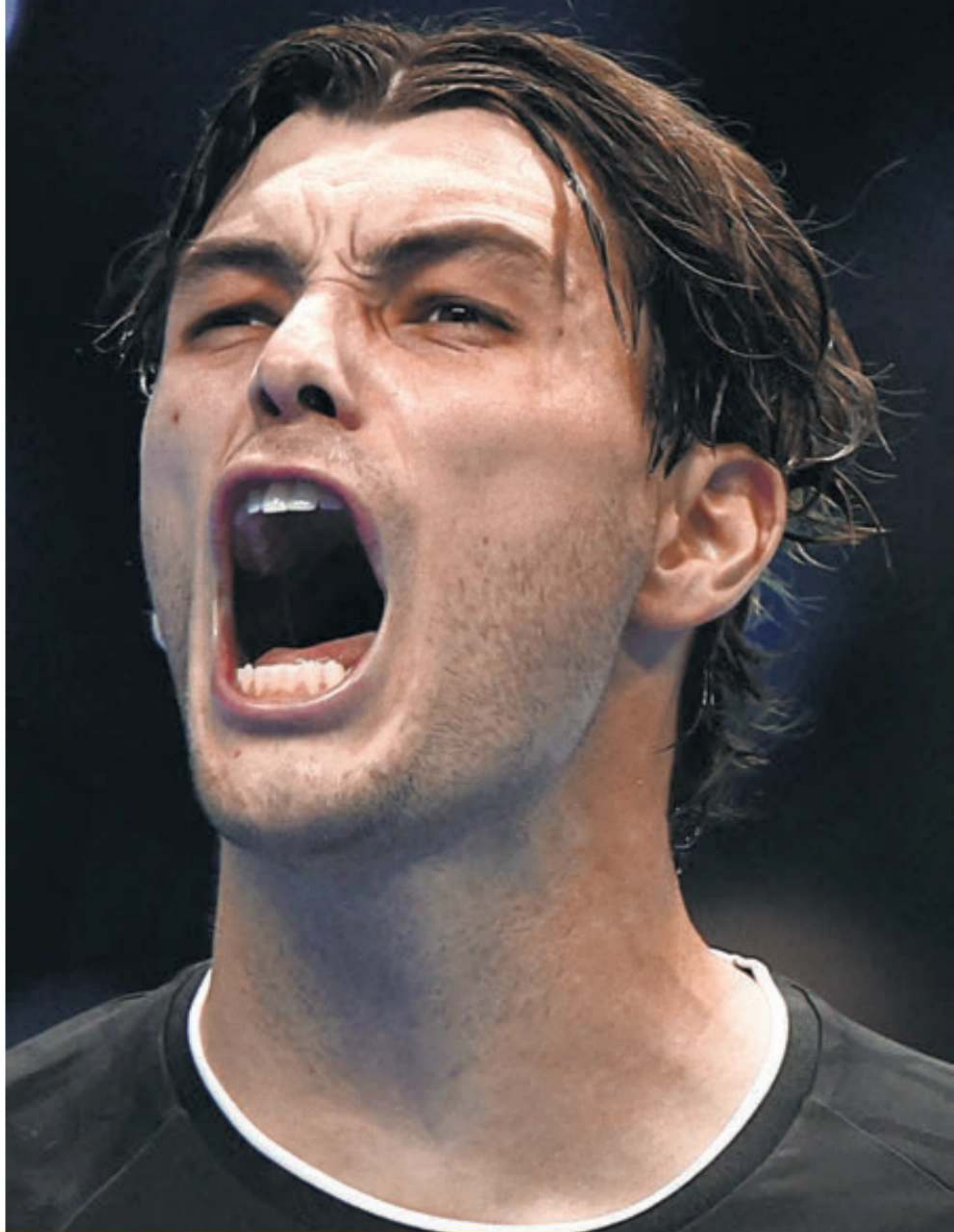
"I have no question Sinner will be a force next year," said Courier. "But will he play? WADA may suspend him for a year or two."

Sinner maintains he has "a clear conscience" regarding the two positive drug tests from last March. The World Anti-Doping Agency has appealed an innocent verdict delivered in September, and the Court of Arbitration for Sport will issue its final ruling early next year.

The other question involves Djokovic. The GOAT decided not to defend his ATP Finals title. If you're wondering what the ever-intriguing Serb has been up to — or on — check out the incredible photo of Djokovic showcasing his incomparable balance and flexibility while doing splits on a tennis net.

"This is an absolute fake photo, and I love it," said an amused Courier. "[But] if this is real, he's up there with [high-wire daredevils] The Flying Wallendas."

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ALTHOUGH FRITZ HAS CLIMBED TO A CAREER-BEST NO. 4, HE WILL NEED TO IMPROVE HIS VOLLEYS AND ATHLETICISM TO UPEND SINNER AND ALCARAZ IN BEST-OF-FIVE-SET ENCOUNTERS AT THE MAJORS

